

SORBIC ACID

_____Name

_____Date

also called... **2-propenyl-acrylic acid**, **2,4-hexadienoic acid**, and **crotylidene acetic acid**. Sorbic acid may be formed in solutions if calcium, sodium, or potassium **sorbate** is present.

What is it?

Sorbic acid is a preservative used to prevent yeast and mold growth.

Where might it be found?

Cosmetics
Face powder
Moisturizing cream
Moist towelettes
Topical medicaments
Tobacco products
Alkyd coatings
Drying oils
Adhesives
Glues
Inks
Paints
Varnishes
Leather tanning agents
Metalworking fluids
Some oral medications
Some cortisone creams

How to avoid it:

To avoid sorbic acid check the complete ingredient list of each product you use. For products already at home that do not list ingredients, go to the store and inspect the original box or package.

Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or at websites such as

<http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>,
<http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or
<http://www.drugstore.com>.

LOW SORBIC ACID DIET

Your doctor may advise you to try at least one month on a diet to reduce your intake of sorbic acid and the related sorbates listed above. If your skin improves, you may cautiously add back one item per week, watching for worsening.

Avoid foods with sorbic acid or sorbates listed as ingredients. Avoid foods likely to be high in sorbitol, such as:

Beverages –grape and apple flavored beverages, wine, some soft drinks, and some liquor

Certain fruits – apples, glazed cherries, cranberries, currants, pears, plums, prunes, strawberries, and products with these fruits

Candies – almond base, chocolates, jellied candy

Dairy – cheeses, cheese spreads, dips, yogurt, ice cream, light butter, margarine, sour cream

Desserts – baking mixes, cakes, cookies, doughs, fudges, icings, pies and fillings, sherbet with the above-listed fruits, syrup, toppings

Other – chestnuts, dressings, flour (esp. rye bread), frozen pizza, marinades, mayonnaise, olives, pickles, refrigerated salads with meats or shellfish, sauerkraut, seaweed, smoked and salted fish, some breads, soy sauce